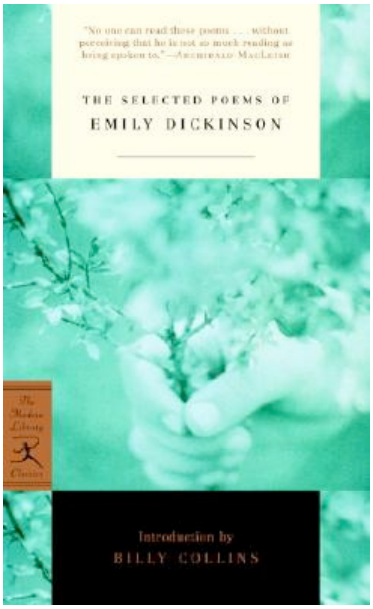
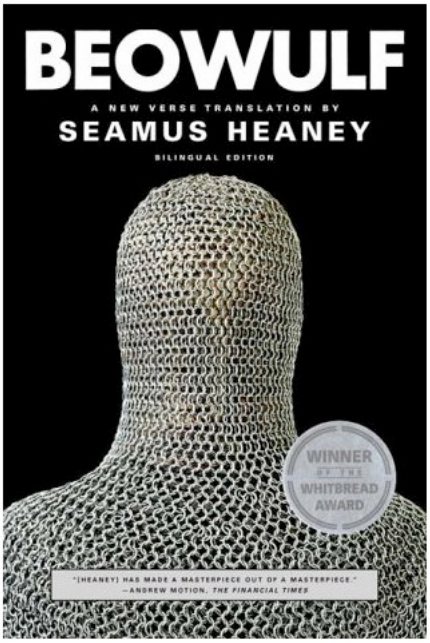
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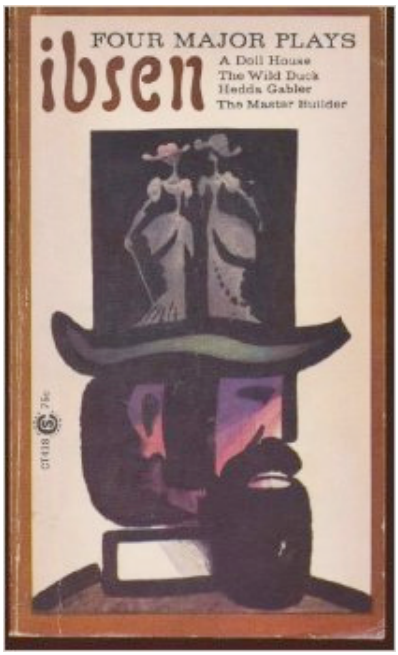
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Invitational B • 2015







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational B • 2015

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The device by which a work presents material that occurrs prior to the opening scene of a work is

   A) digression.
   B) elaboration.
   C) flashback.
   D) flashforward.
   E) foreshadowing.

2. The group of American writers in the 1950s and '60s that included poet Allen Ginsberg and novelist Jack Kerouac and who were in rebellion against what they considered failures of American culture is the

   A) Angry Young Men.
   B) Beat Generation.
   C) Fugitives.
   D) Lollards.
   E) Muckrakers.

3. The 1971 Pulitzer Prize for Drama was awarded to the author of the novel *The Pigman* for his compelling play *The Effect of Gamma Rays on Man-in-the-Moon Marigolds*,

   A) Edward Albee.
   B) Charles Fuller.
   C) David Mamet.
   D) Neil Simon.
   E) Paul Zindel.

4. **Not** a novel written by the nineteenth-century American author Samuel Langhorne Clemens is

   A) *The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*.
   B) *The Prince and the Pauper*.
   C) *Pudd'nhead Wilson*.
   D) *The Red Badge of Courage*.
   E) *Roughing It*.

5. The figure of speech in which a similarity between two objects is directly expressed and which is characterized by an introductory word such as *like*, *as*, *resembles*, *compare*, *than*, and *unlike* is the

   A) analogue.
   B) metaphor.
   C) metonymy.
   D) simile.
   E) verisimilitude.

6. The recipient of the 1973 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for *The Optimist's Daughter* is

   A) Toni Morrison.
   B) E. Annie Proulx.
   C) Marilynne Robinson.
   D) Carol Shields.
   E) Eudora Welty.

7. A lighter form of drama that aims primarily to amuse and is characterized by, among other aspects, both lifelike characters and a sustained plot is

   A) comedy.
   B) farce.
   C) melodrama.
   D) parody.
   E) tragicomedy.

8. The genre of novel dominated by social customs, conventions, and habits of a particular social class, which is always characterized by realism and at times by satire, is the

   A) novel of character.
   B) novel of incident.
   C) novel of manners.
   D) novel of sensibility.
   E) novel of the soil.

9. All of the poetic feet listed below can comprise duple meter, with the exception of

   A) dactylic.
   B) iambic.
   C) pyrrhic.
   D) spondaic.
   E) trochaic.

10. The time in English literature between the period during which French was the language of English court life and the appearance of Modern English writings is known as the

    A) Anglo-Saxon Period.
    B) Jacobean Age.
    C) Middle English Period.
    D) Old English Period.
    E) Renaissance.

11. The derogatory term applied contemptuously to characterize the "tribe" of bad writers and hacks living in central London since the eighteenth century is

A) Angry Young Men.
B) Grub Street.
C) the Martian School.
D) the Satanic School.
E) Spasmodics.

12. A play on words based on the similarity of sound between two words with different meanings is called a(n)

A) cliché.
B) double entendre.
C) litotes.
D) oxymoron.
E) pun.

13. **Not** a genre associated with the Anglo-Saxon Period of English literary history is the

A) art epic.
B) folk epic.
C) homily.
D) religious narrative.
E) riddle.

14. The placing of a sentence element out of its normal position, especially the ordering of the words in a line of poetry to accommodate rhyme and rhythm, is

A) accentualism.
B) enjambment.
C) inversion.
D) ornamentalism.
E) uchronia.

15. A term often applied to the Neoclassic Period in English Literature and sometimes to the Revolutionary and Early National Period in American Literature because these periods emphasized self-knowledge, self-control, the rule of order, as well as decorum in life and art, is the

A) Age of Johnson.
B) Age of Reason.
C) Augustan Age.
D) Period of the Confessional Self.
E) Realistic Period.

16. The twentieth-century American author of *The Old Man and the Sea*, *For Whom the Bell Tolls*, *Islands in the Stream*, and *A Moveable Feast* is

A) Saul Bellow.
B) William Faulkner.
C) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
D) Ernest Hemingway.
E) John Steinbeck.

17. The currently influential African American poet and recipient of the 1994 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for his collection *Neon Vernacular* is

A) James Baldwin.
B) Alex Haley.
C) Yusef Komunyakaa.
D) August Wilson.
E) Richard Wright.

18. Generally, a patterning of vowel sounds without regard to consonants is called

A) assonance.
B) balance.
C) concordance.
D) consonance.
E) dissonance.

19. The playwright responsible for the comedies *All's Well That Ends Well*, *Much Ado about Nothing*, and *A Midsummer Night's Dream* is

A) Francis Beaumont.
B) John Fletcher.
C) Thomas Kyd.
D) Christopher Marlowe.
E) William Shakespeare.

20. The French writer whom the Nobel committee considered an "author of new departures, poetic adventure and sensual ecstasy, explorer of a humanity beyond and below the reigning civilization" and who received the 2008 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) André Gide.
B) Jean-Marie Gustave Le Clézio.
C) François Mauriac.
D) Jean-Paul Sartre.
E) Claude Simon.

21. The figure of speech that may be used to heighten effect, including for humorous effect, through exaggeration is

A) gigantism.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) meiosis.
E) understatement.

22. **Not** a form of verse is the

A) ballad.
B) *canzone*.
C) haiku.
D) sonnet.
E) stanza.

23. The group of American writers, born around 1900, some of whom served in the First World War and reacted during the 1920s against certain tendencies of older writers of their time is known as the

A) Beat Generation.
B) Black Mountain Group.
C) Knickerbocker Group.
D) Lost Generation.
E) New York School.

24. Drama that presents a view of the ridiculousness and ludicrousness of the human condition through its abandonment of the usual or rational devices and by its use of nonrealistic form is known as

A) *reductio ad absurdum*.
B) Theater of Cruelty.
C) Theater of the Absurd.
D) tragedy of blood.
E) tragicomedy.

25. A form of light verse that follows a definite pattern, including the use of the anapestic foot, which originated as epigrammatic song but now addresses, among a wide range of subject matter, the manners, the morals, and the peculiarities of imaginary people, is the

A) doggerel.
B) epigram.
C) limerick.
D) *vers de société*.
E) verset.

26. The period of American literature in which Benjamin Franklin, Anne Bradstreet, and Jonathan Edwards flourished as authors is called the

A) Colonial Period.
B) Postmodern Period.
C) Realistic Period.
D) Revolutionary and Early National Period.
E) Romantic Period.

27. The author of the Old English epic *Beowulf* is

A) Alfred the Great.
B) Cædmon.
C) M. S. Exeter.
D) unknown.
E) the Venerable Bede.

28. The nineteenth-century period during which the United States experienced its first great creative wave—the period of Hawthorne, Melville, Poe, Thoreau, and Emerson, among others—is the

A) Colonial Period, 1607-1765.
B) Federalist Period, 1790-1830.
C) Realistic Period, 1865-1900.
D) Revolutionary/Early National Period, 1765-1830.
E) Romantic Period, 1830-1865.

29. The turn in thought—from question to answer; problem to solution—that occurs at the beginning of the sestet in an Italian sonnet (and some other forms) is the

A) catastrophe.
B) complication.
C) exposition.
D) reversal.
E) volta.

30. The group of eighteenth-century poets, both British and American, who wrote poems on death and immortality that attempted to establish an atmosphere of pleasing gloom in order to call up the horrors of death through the imagery of the charnel house is the

A) Graveyard School.
B) Kailyard School.
C) Lake School.
D) Satanic School.
E) Spasmodic School.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Henrik Ibsen's *A Doll House*.
Items 37-42 are associated with Seamus Heaney's translation of *Beowulf*.
Items 43-50 are associated with Emily Dickinson's poetry (selected).

31. In Henrik Ibsen's *Doll House* the pivotal declaration "I'm the one who saved Torvald's life" is offered, in conversation, by

A) Helmer.
B) Krogstad.
C) Linde.
D) Nora.
E) Rank.

32. Needing to "win back as much respect as possible here in town," and affirming that "the job in the back [is] like the first rung" is

A) Helene.
B) Krogstad.
C) Nora.
D) Rank.
E) Torvald.

33. The conversation regarding "sacred duties" takes place between

A) Nora and Anne-Marie.
B) Nora and Christine.
C) Nora and Helmer.
D) Nora and Nils.
E) Nora and Rank.

34. Nora's response, "And it is," to Helmer's observation, "[Y]ou dance as if your life were at stake," constitutes

A) cosmic irony.
B) dramatic irony.
C) hyperbole.
D) prolepsis.
E) syllepsis.

35. The differential between the date of Nora's father's death and the date on which her dated father's signature appears as cosigner on the loan is

A) one day.
B) five days.
C) four days.
D) three days.
E) two days.

36. The argument for a relationship in terms of "two shipwrecked people [reaching] across to each other" involves

A) Helmer and Nora.
B) Helmer and Rank.
C) Krogstad and Mrs. Linde.
D) Nora and Helene.
E) Nora and Rank.

37. In Heaney's *Beowulf*, the queen who sometimes "hand[s] out / a torque to a warrior" and is known as a "peace pledge between nations" is

A) Aethelflaed.
B) Cynethryth.
C) Ealhswith.
D) Ingeld the Heathobard.
E) Wealhtheow.

38. The meaningful kenning "monstrous hell-bride" refers to

A) Grendel's mother.
B) Hulga Hopewell.
C) Marie Devlin.
D) Unferth.
E) Wealhtheow.

39. "He has no idea of the arts of war, / of shield or sword-play, although he does possess / a wild strength" describes

A) Beowulf.
B) Grendel.
C) Hrothgar.
D) Naegling.
E) Wiglaf.

40. The aspect of Anglo-Saxon prosody that shows forth strongly in the line "away with a will in their wood-wreathed ship" is

A) alliteration.
B) elegiac tone.
C) kenning.
D) personification.
E) vorticism.

41. The "great mead-hall / meant to be a wonder of the world forever" is named

A) Barad-dur.
B) Brandy Hall.
C) Heorot.
D) Hrothgar.
E) Hrunting.

42. **No**t a kenning describing the dragon Beowulf encounters is

A) cave-guard.
B) ground-burner.
C) hoard-guard.
D) mound-keeper.
E) terror-monger.

Items 43-47 refer to Emily Dickinson's

[A wounded deer leaps highest]

A wounded deer leaps highest,
I've heard the hunter tell;
'T is but the ecstasy of death,
And then the brake is still.

The smitten rock that gushes,
The trampled steel that springs:
A cheek is always redder
Just where the hectic stings!

Mirth is the mail of anguish,
In which it caution arm
Lest anybody spy the blood
And "you're hurt" exclaim!

43. The third line of Dickinson's "[A wounded deer leaps highest]" features the first in a series of

A) allusions.
B) hyperboles.
C) metaphors.
D) paradoxes.
E) similes.

44. The linking of enlivenment ("ecstasy" and "mirth," for example) with violence ("wounded" and "anguish," for example) underscores the third stanza's

A) incoherent syntax.
B) juxtaposing of appearances and reality.
C) push to point out any spilling of blood.
D) reliance on anatomical imagery.
E) shift from a wounded deer to a wounded hunter.

45. The persona's observation that "[m]irth is the mail of anguish" suggests that people tend to

A) conceal what is painful.
B) enjoy going into battle.
C) forget the difficulties of life.
D) throw caution to the wind.
E) write a letter about happiness and pain.

46. Line 4's *brake* is a(n)

A) deer's back.
B) end of life.
C) form of death dance.
D) type of fern.
E) wound.

47. The "smitten rock that gushes" is a(n)

A) amorous pet rock.
B) biblical allusion.
C) geological phenomenon.
D) latter-day kenning.
E) unexplained image.

Items 48-50 refer to Emily Dickinson's

["A route of evanescence"]

A route of evanescence
With a revolving wheel;
A resonance of emerald
A rush of cochineal;
And every blossom on the bush
Adjusts its tumbled head,—
The mail from Tunis, probably,
An easy morning's ride.

48. The first line's *evanescence* refers to the quality of

A) escapism.
B) fleetingness.
C) gyration.
D) permanence.
E) vorticism.

49. Line 3's "resonance of emerald" is an example of

A) chiaroscuro.
B) mosaic.
C) sfumato.
D) symbolism.
E) synæsthesia.

50. Dickinson's "[A route of evanescence]" has as its subject the

A) hummingbird.
B) invention of the wheel.
C) pony express.
D) range of colors from cochineal to emerald.
E) route of a morning's ride.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-54 refer to Henry Taylor's

Green Springs the Tree

My young son lurches halfway down the stair
or shrieks and totters midway through a climb
from the wobbling bookcase to the rocking chair.
I freeze and hold my breath. Most of the time
I am too far away to break the fall
that seldom comes. Instead, I stoop and bend
with him, as if threads of remote control
could reel out and connect him to my hand
that strains against his fall, against my leap
to rescue him. My twisting body prays
for skill in this, the high wire he will keep
both of us on as we rehearse the ways
to braid these strands of inheritance
and teach poor body English how to dance.

51. The form of Taylor's "Green Springs the Tree" is the

A) English sonnet.
B) Italian sonnet.
C) Miltonic sonnet.
D) Petrarchan sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

52. The phrase "the high wire he will keep / both of us on as we rehearse the ways [. . .]" (lines 11-12) is

A) allusory.
B) hyperbolic.
C) metaphorical.
D) metonymic.
E) pyramidal.

53. The type of rhyme that dominates the sonnet is

A) compound rhyme.
B) eye rhyme.
C) feminine rhyme.
D) masculine rhyme.
E) slant rhyme.

54. The poem's controlling image might be best understood in terms of a

A) circus.
B) grammar lesson.
C) green tree.
D) marionette.
E) strands of deoxyribonucleic acid.

Items 55-57 Siegfried Sassoon's

Does It Matter?

Does it matter?—losing your legs?
For people will always be kind,
And you need not show that you mind
When others come in after hunting
To gobble their muffins and eggs.

Does it matter?—losing you sight?
There's such splendid work for the blind;
And people will always be kind,
As you sit on the terrace remembering
And turning your face to the light.

Do they matter-those dreams in the pit?
You can drink and forget and be glad,
And people won't say that you're mad;
For they know that you've fought for your country,
And no one will worry a bit.

55. The stanza form that makes up Sassoon's poem is

A) bob and wheel.
B) clerihew.
C) pantoum.
D) pentastich.
E) poulter's measure.

56. Sassoon's "Does It Matter?" relies on a sequence of

A) apostrophes.
B) euphemisms.
C) invocations.
D) metaphors.
E) rhetorical questions.

57. The tone of Sassoon's poem is

A) affirmative.
B) compassionate.
C) optimistic.
D) patriotic.
E) satiric.

Items 58-61 refer to the Old English poem

The Seafarer
[excerpted]

About myself I can utter a truth-song,
tell journeys—how I in toil-days
torment-time often endured,
abode and still do bitter breast-care,
sought in my ship many a care-hall,
horrible waves' rolling, where narrow night-watch
often has kept me at the ship's stem
when it dashes by cliffs. Pinched by the cold
were my feet, bound by frost's
frozen fetters, where those cares sighed
hot about heart; hunger within tore
the mind of the sea-weary one. That man knows not,
to whom on earth fairest falls,
how I, care-wretched, ice-cold sea
dwelt on in winter along the exile-tracks,
bereaved both of friend and of kin,
behung with rime-crystals. Hail showers flew.
I heard nothing there but the sea's sounding,
ice-cold wave. At times the swan's song
served me for merriment, gannet's crying
and curlew's sound instead of men's laughter,
mew's singing in place of mead-drink.
Storms there beat stone-cliffs, where starn, icy-feathered,
answered and called to them; often the eagle screamed,
dew-feathered fowl: no sheltering kinsman
brought consolation to a destitute life.

58. The tone of the Anglo-Saxon poem "The Seafarer" is, characteristically

A) didactic.
B) elegiac.
C) indignant.
D) mocking.
E) optimistic.

59. The two halves of the four-stressed-syllable lines that characterize the poem, especially evident in the alliterative lines 6 and 11, are known as

A) caesuras.
B) distichs.
C) hemistichs.
D) hiatuses.
E) stichs.

60. The kenning serving to characterize the tone of "The Seafarer" is

A) breast-care (line 4).
B) care-wretched (line 14).
C) exile-tracks (line 15).
D) mead-drink (line 22).
E) night-watch (line 6).

61. The poem's pervasive imagery is overwhelmingly

A) auditory.
B) gustatory.
C) olfactory.
D) tactile.
E) visual.

Items 62-65 refer to Robert Herrick's

To His Mistress Objecting to Him Neither Toying nor Talking

You say I love not, 'cause I do not play
Still with your curls, and kiss the time away.
You blame me too, because I can't devise
Some sport to please those babies in your eyes:
By love's religion, I must here confess it,
The most I love when I the least express it.
Small griefs find tongues: full casks are ever found
To give (if any, yet) but little sound.
Deep waters noiseless are; and this we know,
That chiding streams betray small depth below.
So, when love speechless is, she doth express
A depth in love and that depth bottomless.
Now, since my love is tongueless, know me such
Who speak but little 'cause I love so much.

62. The strength of the poem's persona's protest that true love is "tongueless" (line 13) is found in

A) lines 1-2.
B) lines 3-4.
C) lines 5-6.
D) lines 9-10.
E) lines 13-14.

63. "The most I love when I the least express it" (6) is (a)

A) hypallage.
B) hyperbole.
C) litotes.
D) paradox.
E) tautology.

64. The repetition of sibilant sounds that characterizes Herrick's poem, especially the lines "because I can't devise / Some sport to please those babies in your eyes" (3-4) is called

A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) dissonance.
D) resonance.
E) sigmatism.

65. The three phrases "I do not play / Still with your curls" (lines 1-2), "[d]eep waters noiseless are" (line 9), and "when love speechless is" (line 11) are examples of

A) enjambment.
B) inversion.
C) litotes.
D) metathesis.
E) parenthesis.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Emily Dickinson's "[As imperceptibly as grief]," and address the effectiveness of Dickinson's similes.

[As imperceptibly as Grief]

As imperceptibly as grief
The summer lapsed away,—
Too imperceptible, at last,
To seem like perfidy.* — **betrayal; lack of loyalty**

A quietness distilled,
As twilight long begun,
Or Nature spending with herself
Sequestered* afternoon. — **set apart; secluded**

The dusk drew earlier in,
The morning foreign shone,—
A courteous, yet harrowing* grace, — **acutely distressing**
As guest who would be gone.

And thus, without a wing,
Or service of a keel,* — **stabilizing structure of a boat**
Our summer made her light escape
Into the beautiful.

Emily Dickinson

ANSWER SHEET

UIL Literary Criticism

Items 1-30 **1** *point each*

1. ____
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Items 31-65 **2** *points each*

31. ____
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Part 3

contestant number

SCORE

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties.

Simply adjust ranking.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

FIRST GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

\+

number correct x 2 _____

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initials

SECOND GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

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THIRD GRADER

number correct x 1 _____

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KEY

UIL Literary Criticism Invitational B • 2015

line arrows up ➔

1.	C	200
2.	B	51
3.	E	608
4.	D	568
5.	D	445
6.	E	603
7.	A	98
8.	C	330
9.	A	129
10.	C	299
11.	B	224
12.	E	390
13.	A	41
14.	C	257
15.	B	9
16.	D	582
17.	C	605
18.	A	43
19.	E	533
20.	B	601
21.	B	242
22.	E	454
23.	D	279
24.	C	2
25.	C	272
26.	A	96
27.	D	
28.	E	422
29.	E	498
30.	A	221
31.	D	53
32.	B	64
33.	C	111
34.	B	92
35.	D	66
36.	C	96
37.	E	2016-20
38.	A	1259
39.	B	681-83
40.	A	216
41.	C	78
42.	E	765
43.	D	349
44.	B	
45.	A	
46.	D	
47.	B	
48.	B	
49.	E	469
50.	A	
51.	A	173
52.	C	
53.	D	287
54.	D	
55.	D	357
56.	E	412
57.	E	
58.	B	167
59.	C	228
60.	A	266
61.	A	
62.	D	
63.	D	349
64.	E	
65.	B	257

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

DO NOT mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e, to the Signet *House*, to the Norton *Beowulf*, and to Collins's Dickinson collection.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Emily Dickinson's "[As imperceptibly as grief]"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of the effectiveness of Emily Dickinson's use of the simile in "[As imperceptibly as grief]" include

alliteration,
assonance,
imagery,
internal rhyme,
inversion,
oxymoron,
personification,
sigmatism,
synecdoche,
tenor,
tone, and
vehicle.

The contestant should recognize that each of the first three stanzas turns on a simile and that the final stanza serves to sum up the overall qualities of three of the poem's four vehicles (the comparison's immediate subject) as the summer's "light escape" (line 15), summer's exit—initially argued to be perfidious (4)—being the collective tenor (the poem's intentional subject). Something might be made of the positioning of each of the succeeding stanza's dominant similes: the first stanza begins with a simile; the second stanza's simile is found on that stanza's second line; the third stanza presents its simile on its final line. If this sequence is part of the student's observation, something should be noted regarding the positioning of the poem's tenor "summer['s making] her light escape" in its own, the poem's final, stanza.

The focus of a good response to the poem is the aggregate of the comparisons, which Dickinson, as speaker, draws through the poem. The first stanza finds an emotive aspect of summer's lapsing and presents it as grief: the summer is passive in this comparison. The second stanza shifts from an imperceptible lapsing to a process of distillation and sequestering (summer yet passive; overarching Nature as active). The third stanza colors the shift with anxiety, the simile suggesting a decidedly active summer (a "guest who would be gone").

Dickinson's synecdochical "without a wing, / Or service of a keel" (13-14) sustains the effortlessness, the stealthiness, and the quickness of summer's exit as suggested by the similes dominating the first three stanzas. The resolution of the poem's imagery and sentiment (15-16) [the first stanza's grief, the second stanza's isolation, and the third stanza's "harrowing grace" (11)],"[i]nto the beautiful," controls, finally, the tone of the poem.